

Top CSS Interview Questions for Microsoft

1. How does CSS specificity work?

Specificity defines which CSS rule is applied when multiple rules target the same element.

- Inline styles = 1000
- ID selectors = 0100
- Class/attribute/pseudo-class = 0010
- Element/pseudo-element = 0001

Highest specificity wins. If equal, the later rule overrides.

2. Difference between em, rem, px, %, and vh/vw?

px - absolute; em - relative to parent; rem - relative to root; % - relative to parent; vh/vw - relative to viewport. Use rem for scalable text, %, vh/vw for responsive layouts.

3. visibility: hidden vs display: none

- visibility: hidden hides the element but keeps the space.
- display: none removes it from layout.

4. CSS Box Model

Box model = Content + Padding + Border + Margin.

Use box-sizing: border-box to include padding and border in width/height.

5. Creating Responsive Design

- Use media queries
- Use responsive units (em, %, vw, etc.)
- Use Flexbox/Grid

6. CSS Cascade

Cascade determines final style based on:

1. Importance (!important)

2. Specificity

3. Source order

7. Pseudo-classes vs Pseudo-elements

- Pseudo-class: :hover, :first-child (based on element state)
- Pseudo-element: ::before, ::after (target element parts)

8. Positioning in CSS

static: normal flow

relative: relative to itself

absolute: nearest positioned ancestor

fixed: relative to viewport

sticky: switches between relative and fixed

9. Reflow vs Repaint

Repaint: style changes (e.g., color).

Reflow: layout changes (DOM/layout).

Reflow is more performance-intensive.

10. Best Practices for Scalable CSS

- Use BEM naming
- Use variables
- Avoid deep nesting
- Use flexbox/grid
- Split code into components